

CURRICULUM VITAE

PERSONAL

I am an eager and creative data scientist from the Netherlands. Currently, I pursue my PhD in political communication, where I focus on the multimodal representation of politicians in online media.

INFO

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WIES RUYTERS



04 / 03 / 1998

LANGUAGES

Dutch mother tongue
English fluent
Spanish advanced
Italian beginner

SKILLS

Python advanced
HTML/CSS beginner
AFdesign advanced
Powerpoint advanced

INTERESTS

Culture and learning languages
Sports running, road cycling, CrossFit, yoga
Nature hiking, camping
Hobby recreational vegetarian chef
Art poetry writer, visualizer of technical stuff, concert visitor

EDUCATION

MSc Data Science in Engineering, TU/e
Thesis: “Behind the Political Frame: Exploring Visualization Methods to Increase Bias Awareness and Mitigate Framing Effects on Social Media” (9.0/10)
GPA: 8.3 (Cum Laude)
Minor: Department of Digital Humanities, University of Bologna (9.8/10)

BSc Industrial Engineering, TU/e
Thesis: “Enhancing Sustainable Travel Behavior Through Redesigning Information Sharing” (8/10)
GPA: 7.2

EXPERIENCE

PhD candidate From September 2023, Wageningen University and Research
Project: VICI - The mobilization of political dissatisfaction: causes, content, consequences

Data Analyst 2022, BusinessDev Holland
Project: Exploratory cost development analysis of heatpumps in The Netherlands

Central Introduction Committee 2021, TU/e

Student Assistant 2018 - 2022, TU/e
Positions: Teacher Support, Information Team

EXTRACURRICULAR

EXPEDITIE NEXT, editions 2025 (Roermond), 2026 (Enkhuizen)
Responsibility: Creator and host of an extracurricular activity for primary school pupils from all across the country.
Topic: Pupils were to design their "ideal prime minister" through coloring pages. The activity aimed to provoke reflections on political representation among youth.

Workshop host, 2024 - current
Responsibility: Creator and host of Polarization workshops on public schools and institutions.
Topic: Societal polarization and political communication.

WASS PhD Council, 2024 - current
Wageningen University and Research

Social Volunteer, 2023 - 2026
City of Utrecht, The Netherlands
Foundations: (1) "Mijn Wijk Jouw Wijk", organizer of meet-and-eat evenings to connect refugees with neighborhood residents; (2) De Tussenvoorziening, buddy project

Unleash Innovation Lab Participant 2019, United Nations, Shengzhen, China
SDG group: Responsible Consumption and Production - Sustainable Tourism

PR and communications manager 2018, TU/e Student Team SOLID

current position

PhD candidate *September 2023 - September 2027, Wageningen University and Research*

Project: The mobilization of political dissatisfaction: causes, content, consequences

Funding: NWO-VICI (Dutch Research Council)

Main responsibility: Studying the multi-modal representations of politicians with a data-driven approach. I work with news data and social media data, which I collect myself, as well as public opinion data, which we collect with the team.

publications

Wies Ruyters, Susan Vermeer & Rens Vliegenthart (forthcoming) *Modalities matter: the effect of monomodal versus multimodal news coverage on party leader recall*, [Oxford Handbook of Personality Politics](#)

Wies Ruyters, Susan Vermeer, Sanne Kruikemeier & Rens Vliegenthart (2025) *Embedding, embedding on the wall; who is the most prominent politician of them all? Exploring automated methods to study multimodal political news coverage*, [Communication Methods and Measures](#)
DOI: 10.1080/19312458.2025.2558736

visiting scholarship

University of Georgia (UGA), Athens, Georgia (USA)

Lab: Multimodal Computational Communication Lab

Host: dr. Yilang Peng

conference presentations

September 2026 *ECPR general conference, Krakow (Jagiellonian University)*

Presentation 1: The Populist Gaze: A multi-modal analysis of populist framing on social versus news media (Work in Progress)

Presentation 2: Connected Conservatives: The Transnationalization of Far Right Discourse on X.com (Work in Progress)

June 2026 *ICA annual conference, Cape Town (Stellenbosch University)*

Presentation: Modalities matter: the effect of monomodal versus multimodal news coverage on party leader recall

September 2025 *ECREA interim conference, Innsbruck (University of Innsbruck)*

Presentation: Modality matters?! How multimodal media prominence drives political recognition and party support (Work in Progress)

June 2025 *ICA pre-conference, Denver Colorado (University of Denver)*

Conference theme: *Frames of Visual Transition*

Presentation: Modality matters?! How multimodal media prominence drives political recognition and party support (Work in Progress)

April 2025 *CompTEXT conference, Vienna (University of Vienna)*

Presentation: Modality matters?! How multimodal media prominence drives political recognition and party support (Work in Progress)

February 2025 *Etmaal of communication science, Brugge (KU Leuven)*

Netherlands-Flanders Communication Association

Presentation: Beyond words: How multimodal media prominence drives political recognition and party support (Work in Progress)

May 2024 *CompTEXT conference, Amsterdam (VU Amsterdam)*

Presentation: Multi-modal news framing in the wild: an in-depth analysis of political news published by NOS.nl during the Dutch parliamentary elections of 2023. (Work in Progress)

February 2024 *Etmaal of communication science, Rotterdam (Erasmus school of history, culture, and communication)*

Presentation: Newsworthify me, positively or negatively: a multi-modal approach to examine media frames during 2023 Dutch parliamentary elections (Work in Progress)

poster presentation

Februari 2026 *Etmaal of communication science, Wageningen (Wageningen University and Research)*

Poster: The Populist Gaze

PhD courses

January 2024 *The Responsibility and Ethics of AI*

Host: Eindhoven University of Technology

Grade: 8/10

summer schools

July 2026 *ECPR standing group on Extremism and Democracy Summer School, Alma Mater Studiorum (University of Bologna)*

Host: European Consortium for Political Research (ECPR)

August 2024 *International Summer School of Political Communication, Università degli Studi di Milano*

Host: International Communication Association (ICA)

June 2024 *SICSS Summer Institute for Computational Social Sciences, University of Amsterdam*

Host: Amsterdam Institute for Computational Social Science Research

event moderation & invited talks

October 2025 *WASS PhD Day: Perspective on Peace*

Location: Wageningen University and Research, Omnia conference center

Responsibility: Theme design, Communications & PR, host, panel moderation

February 2025 *Model United Nations Amersfoort (FAMUN)*

Location: Farel College, Amersfoort

Responsibility: Keynote speaker

Talk: The twentyfirst century newsscape - an introduction to framing and the consequential reception of information